Simon Aquino

Engineering Manager · Cloud Enablement · Internal Developer Platforms, Team Building & AI-Assisted Delivery

London, United Kingdom (open to relocation)

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Profile

Platform and SRE leader with 16+ years across financial services, government and high-growth technology, hands-on in Go and Python. Builds and scales teams and treats the platform as a product: self-service capability so application teams deploy and operate independently.

- **Team Building & Scaling:** Built and line-managed teams (employees and contractors): hired around 10 engineers at JPMorgan Chase, including senior and lead roles, and built a Haleon team from zero to 6, coaching engineers through feedback and career development.
- **Organisational Design:** Built the business case to split the JPMorgan Chase team for scale and selected the new managers; the proposal was approved and permanently adopted.
- **Platform as a Product:** Drove "Golden Path" platform strategy (Crossplane, ArgoCD) at JPMorgan Chase and an Internal Developer Platform at Barclays that cut onboarding from weeks to minutes, preserving team autonomy.
- **AI Enablement:** Led team adoption of AI-assisted delivery (GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, custom skills) with quality gates — AI code review backed by automated tests, plus human review — delivering a production AKS platform at Haleon in about six weeks against a typical 6–12 months.
- **Security & Compliance:** Delivered the JPMorgan Chase platform within ISO 27001/SOC 2-aligned frameworks, and automated SOX compliance reporting for Identity & Access Management (IAM) governance at Haleon.

Professional Experience

Haleon (GSK Consumer Healthcare)

London, UK

Engineering Manager, Data & Platform Engineering — *Apr 2025 – Sep 2025, Mar 2026 – Present (rehired)*

- **Team Building & People Leadership:** Built and led a new team from zero to 6 engineers, hiring them and line-managing the team (employees and contractors) through 1:1 coaching, performance feedback, and career development.
- **AI-Assisted Delivery:** Led the team's adoption of AI-assisted development (GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, custom team skills, AI code review backed by automated tests), delivering a production AKS platform in about six weeks against a typical 6–12 months.
- **Greenfield Delivery:** Led delivery of a greenfield data platform for Identity & Access Management (IAM) governance, replacing manual audit processes with automated SOX compliance reporting (PA-02/AM-02 controls); managed the project budget and iterative releases aligned to audit timelines.
- **Migrated:** Moved a team working on a SAP ERP platform from Azure DevOps to GitHub, covering source control and CI/CD.
- **Technology:** Dagster/Python Medallion ETL pipeline on Azure (AKS, ADLS Gen2, PostgreSQL), with Terraform Cloud, Helm, and GitHub Actions.

Barclays

London, UK

Principal Platform Consultant — *Oct 2025 – Mar 2026*

- **Team Enablement & Coaching:** Led the transformation of a legacy software unit into cloud-native platform engineers through hands-on pair programming, mentoring the internal Tech Lead on platform strategy, team structure, and engineering best practices.
- **Platform Strategy:** Drove the greenfield Internal Developer Platform (IDP) strategy for the Payments division on AWS/EKS (Go, Terraform, Crossplane, Flux, Helm, GitHub Actions), cutting team onboarding from weeks to minutes.
- **Technical Authority:** Acted as Technical Authority within the platform team, defining architecture patterns on AWS/Kubernetes and establishing "Golden Path" standards and automated compliance frameworks that moved legacy systems onto a secure, self-service platform.
- **Reliability:** Architected the platform on AWS/EKS for payment rails with low-latency, high-availability requirements.

JPMorgan Chase

London, UK

Engineering Manager, Cloud Enablement — *Apr 2023 – Mar 2025*

- **Team Leadership & Growth:** Grew the platform team to 13 engineers, hiring around 10 including senior and lead roles, and line-managing the team (employees and contractors) through 1:1 coaching, performance feedback, and career development.
- **Organisational Design:** Recognised the team had outgrown its structure, built the business case to the Engineering Director to split it, and selected the new managers; the proposal was approved and the new structure permanently adopted.
- **Platform Outcomes:** Led the firm-wide GCP landing zones initiative (self-service, isolated environments per team), now running globally, and as the most senior lead in the Platform team set technical direction for the firm-wide GCP and Kubernetes ecosystem (100+ clusters), delivered within ISO 27001/SOC 2-aligned frameworks; mentored peer tech leads across the function and advised senior and C-suite stakeholders on technical direction and spend.
- **Golden Path & Technology:** Drove a "Golden Path" platform strategy with Crossplane and GitOps-driven change management (ArgoCD), with observability via Prometheus/Grafana, improving reliability and developer experience across teams.
- **FinOps:** Embedded FinOps as a core platform capability, giving teams cost visibility and advising senior stakeholders on cloud spend.
- **Reliability Practices:** Set SLOs and on-call and incident practices for the platform team; ran postmortems.

- **AI Enablement:** Delivered AI-ready platform blueprints (Vertex AI integration, data pipelines) on the firm-wide GCP and Kubernetes foundation, enabling teams' transition to data-intensive GenAI workloads.

Deloitte *Copenhagen, Denmark*

Infrastructure DevOps Lead *Mar 2021 – Mar 2023*

- **Cross-Team Coordination:** Led the AWS cloud infrastructure stream for Denmark's Property Tax Platform, coordinating across 3 satellite teams in Denmark and the US to resolve cross-functional architectural blockers.
- **Cost Optimisation:** Consolidated infrastructure, simplifying legacy complexity and reducing monthly cloud operational costs without compromising system performance.
- **Modernisation & Security:** Replaced brittle custom authentication with managed AWS API Gateway, establishing a standardised, secure pattern for external integrations.

Microsoft (for Refinitiv) *London, UK*

Principal Consultant *Nov 2020 – Mar 2021*

- **Migration Delivery:** Served in Microsoft's Professional Services, consulting within the team migrating one of Refinitiv's trading applications from on-prem to Azure, optimising AKS/EventHubs for high-frequency throughput.
- **Architecture:** Took part in architecture meetings to define project scope, develop a proof of concept, and tackle key technical challenges.
- **Environment Delivery:** Led the delivery of the first full development environment, acting as liaison between internal teams and Microsoft.

Selected earlier roles

- Mar 2020 – Oct 2020, **Loveholidays, Lead Platform Engineer:** Resolved latency bottlenecks in Go/Java microservices on GKE, achieving 30% performance gains through Kubernetes autoscaling optimisation.
- Jun 2019 – Mar 2020, **eBay, Lead DevOps Engineer:** Orchestrated the migration of eBay Classifieds to GCP, architecting standardised GKE workflows for distributed European engineering teams.
- Mar 2017 – Feb 2018, **Element Insurance, Senior DevOps Engineer:** Built and managed AWS infrastructure (EC2, S3, Lambda, CloudWatch, DynamoDB) with Terraform.
- Feb 2016 – Feb 2017, **HMRC, Senior DevOps Consultant:** UK Government digital tax at scale.
- Aug 2015 – Feb 2016, **KPMG, DevOps Engineer:** Designed and built multi-tenant AWS infrastructure to deploy the Hortonworks Data Platform for KPMG clients, including data security and infrastructure hardening.
- 2010 – 2011, **Google, Corporate Operations Engineer (intern):** Python/App Engine internal tooling (20% project); Python Readability award (internal code quality).

Skills

Leadership & Strategy	Team Building & Scaling, Org Design, Tech Recruitment, Coaching & Career Development, Platform-as-a-Product, Executive Stakeholder Management, Engineering Strategy, Remote/Distributed Leadership, Project Budgeting, FinOps.
Cloud & Platform	AWS, GCP (Pro Architect), Azure, Kubernetes (EKS, AKS, GKE), Internal Developer Platforms (IDP), Developer Experience (DevEx), Infrastructure as Code (Terraform), Helm, Crossplane, ArgoCD, GitHub Actions, CI/CD.
Architecture & Dev	Go, Python, Distributed Systems, Event-Driven Architecture, Microservices, API Design.
AI-Assisted Delivery	GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, custom team skills, AI code review backed by automated tests.
Ops, Security & Data	SRE Practices, Prometheus, Grafana, DevSecOps, Zero Trust, Identity Governance & IAM, SOX Controls, Data Pipelines (ETL/Medallion), Dagster, PostgreSQL.
Languages	English and Italian (native), German (B2), Danish (A2).

Education

University of Bristol *Bristol, UK*

Master of Engineering (MEng) Hons in Computer Science and Electronics *2012*

Certificates

2025 **Google Cloud Platform (GCP),** Professional Cloud Architect (PCA)

2025 **Google Cloud Platform (GCP),** Generative AI Leader

2014 **Red Hat,** Red Hat Certified System Administrator (RHCSA)